Weekly cetuximab + FOLFIRI

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00328 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Visits, access and care between treatments

Cetuximab on Day 1 and Day 8. Day 1 FOLFIRI includes irinotecan, folinic acid and fluorouracil, followed by a 46-hour fluorouracil infusion with planned disconnection around Day 3. Repeat the reference cycle every 14 days while beneficial and tolerable.

STEP 1

Before the first visit

Confirm the exact regimen, tests, medicines, emergency number and treatment goal. Discuss which central line is suitable and arrange pump training.

STEP 2

At the treatment unit

The first weekly cetuximab infusion takes about two hours; later weekly infusions usually take about one hour. Irinotecan usually takes about 90 minutes. Blood review, preparation, premedicines and observation add time; infusion time is not the total appointment length.

STEP 3

After the infusion

The fluorouracil pump runs for about 46 hours. Confirm where and when it will be disconnected, usually around Day 3; do not disconnect it yourself unless specifically trained.

STEP 4

Between doses

Attend the separate Day 8 cetuximab-only visit. This is not another irinotecan or oxaliplatin day. Use the written symptom and support plan; do not wait for the next appointment if urgent symptoms appear.

STEP 5

The next decision

Confirm the next visit after any delay or dose change. Treatment continues only while the oncology team judges benefit and tolerability acceptable. Follow-up mineral checks continue after the final EGFR-antibody dose where applicable.

Transport and daily life

Plan transport if antihistamines, symptoms or other medicines affect driving. Ask for practical, work, nutrition or emotional support.

If treatment changes

Ask which component has been held and which visits remain. A treatment delay does not automatically cancel blood tests, line care or symptom follow-up.

Observation at every antibody visit

Premedicines and monitoring add time to every cetuximab visit. Your team will confirm the observation period before you leave; do not assume that later visits can omit observation.

Sources: NCCP 00328 v7 · official regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.